IKEH CELESTINE CHUKWUDI

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About Me

Mechanical engineer turned Rust developer, building in the Bitcoin ecosystem. I've written my own Bitcoin wallet library and CLI in Rust, contributed to the Bitcoin Dev Kit, and built Lightning and AI payment projects with hackathon teams. My engineering background taught me to break problems down, and four years of remote review work taught me to get the details right every time. I'm looking for backend, blockchain or AI evaluation roles where I can keep learning and ship reliable work.

Skills

Technical: Solidity (Ethereum Virtual Machine), Cairo, Rust, Rust for Bitcoin, Agentic AI tools, Computer hardware and troubleshooting, Microsoft Office

Professional: Leadership and teamwork, Effective communication, Time management and organisation, Problem solving and safety procedures, Critical thinking and analytical skills

Training

THE BUIDL (Blockheader), Kaduna — 2026 Blockchain and Software Development Training

- Solidity for smart contracts on the Ethereum Virtual Machine (EVM)
- Cairo programming, including the use of agentic AI tools
- Rust programming
- Rust for Bitcoin

Projects

Bitcoin Wallet Crate — Rust | github.com/chukwudiikeh/Wallet_Lib

- Built a reusable Rust library (crate) providing the core Bitcoin wallet functionality.

Bitcoin CLI Wallet — Rust | github.com/chukwudiikeh/Wallet_Cli

- Built a command-line Bitcoin wallet in Rust, using my own wallet crate for all of its core functionality.

Toshi Way: Bitcoin Lightning Escrow — Hackathon team project | github.com/chukwudiikeh/toshi-way

- Built with one teammate an escrow service on the Bitcoin Lightning Network, where a buyer's payment is locked with a hold invoice and released to the seller only when the buyer hands over a secret, with automatic refunds after a deadline.
- Implemented the majority of the Bitcoin and Lightning Network logic, including the hold-invoice escrow flow, while my teammate handled the rest of the application.
- Designed around courier deliveries, with QR-code release at handover and optional arbiters for disputes.

FinPal: AI Purchasing Assistant — PayPal AI Hackathon | github.com/chukwudiikeh/FinPal

- Built with a team an agentic purchasing assistant that checks each purchase against the user's spending rules, compares the price with real market offers and checks the merchant before a PayPal Sandbox payment is authorised.
- Built the backend, designing the decision logic and integrating the PayPal and AI services, using AI-assisted coding tools.
- Decisions come from fixed rules (auto-approve, manual review or block), with an AI model only explaining them in plain language, and every step is recorded in an audit log.

Ethos Protocol: Decentralised Inheritance — Creator and lead developer | github.com/ethos-protocol

- Conceived and designed a decentralised inheritance protocol on Stellar/Soroban that lets users create vaults, manage beneficiaries and automate transfers.
- Wrote the majority of the Rust smart-contract code and designed the core logic, using AI-assisted coding tools, with support from one collaborator.

Open Source Contributions

- **bdk-cli (Bitcoin Dev Kit)** — #353 (merged): made warnings, including the mainnet notice, visible by default, with tests.
- **bdk-cli (Bitcoin Dev Kit)** — #346 (merged): refactored the `compile` command to use a Rust enum for script types, keeping the accepted values in one place.

Work Experience

HUMANATIC, Remote — Call Reviewer | Dec. 2021 – Dec. 2025

- Evaluated and labelled recorded customer calls against detailed client guidelines, with a strong focus on accuracy and consistency.
- Classified calls into predefined categories using set quality criteria, working independently and to deadlines over four years.
- Gave written feedback on unclear or edge cases to help refine categorisation guidelines and improve data quality.

NYSC OFFICE — Corps Liaison Officer (CLO) | July 2023 – July 2024

- Coordinated and managed the activities of Corps members.
- Guided and counselled Corps members.
- Ensured the safety and welfare of all Corps members.

DE MAYOR CORPORATE — Accountant & Data Entry Clerk | Feb. 2024 – April 2024

- Updated existing databases with new entries on a regular basis.
- Managed large volumes of paperwork and records efficiently.
- Provided administrative support to other departments as needed.

HANIGHA NIGERIA LIMITED — Engineering Intern | March 2021 – Oct. 2021

- Learned the mechanisms and operation of agricultural and agro-allied machines.
- Practised joining and machining processes.
- Assisted in the manufacture and fabrication of agricultural and agro-allied machinery.

CROWN STAR COMPUTERS — Computer Artisan | April 2016 – Oct. 2016

- Installed and configured hardware such as motherboards, processors, RAM, hard drives and optical drives.
- Troubleshot computer systems to diagnose hardware and software issues.
- Installed drivers for peripherals such as printers, scanners and webcams.

Education

UNIVERSITY OF NIGERIA, NSUKKA — Nov. 2022 Bachelor of Engineering (B.Eng.) in Mechanical Engineering — Second Class Upper Honours (4.29)

Final Year Research Project: Comparative Study of Biocomposites of Potato Starch and Cassava Starch Reinforced with Coconut Husk

- Compared resins made from potato starch and cassava starch, each reinforced with the same coconut husk fibre, to test the strength of the resin itself as a sustainable composite material.
- Key finding: although cassava yields more starch than potato, the potato starch resin produced the stronger composite.

Certifications

- National Youth Service Corps (NYSC) Certificate — July 2024
- Project Management Certificate — July 2024
- Human Resource Management Certificate — July 2024
- Customer Service Relationship Management Certificate — July 2024
- HSE Level 1, 2 and 3 Certificates — July 2024

Personal Interests

Studying and playing chess

Referees

Available upon request